

GALLERY OF WHITE & TONED GROUNDS

THE PAINTINGS SHOWN HERE demonstrate how important the color of any ground is – from the bright clarity of color that can be produced on a white ground to the economy of painting on a subtle mid-toned ground. A toned ground not only affects the appearance of a color painted immediately on top of it, but also any successive layers of transparent and opaque paint.



Mick Rooney, RA, *Wedding Day Yalalag*, 1991 36 x 28 in (91 x 71 cm)
The principle of opaque highlights and transparent shadows on a dark ground is well illustrated in this painting of a village wedding. Opaque colors are worked stiffly in a scumbled dry brush technique that allows the dark ground color to show through in halftone effects.

Donald Hamilton Fraser, RA, *Grand Canal, Venice*, 1992 30 x 23 in (76 x 58 cm)
This is an excellent example of a painting made directly in an economical style on a white ground. The paint, applied thinly, allows the white ground to illuminate colors and give a clarity and sparkle to the quality of light in the painting. Areas of high contrast add a crisp brightness to the scene.

This detail shows how clean and strong the colors look on a white ground.

The glimpses of white ground still visible help to intensify the appearance of each color.

